Tyep POS

Firebase setup for delivery riders

A beginner-friendly guide for connecting the POS to the rider app

Save this guide and work through it when you have time. You do not need to finish everything in one sitting. The setup creates the online link between your POS and your riders; riders can use mobile data and do not need your shop Wi-Fi password.

Before you begin: You will need a Google account, an internet connection, and access to the project folder on your Mac. Never share rider passwords or put a Firebase service-account private key into the app.

What you will do

• Create a Firebase project and web app.

• Turn on email-and-password sign-in and create individual accounts.

• Create matching manager and rider profiles.

• Add the Firebase settings to both parts of the project.

• Publish the rider app and database security rules, then test one order.

Important: setup is not complete until the last deployment step. Until then, riders will not be able to access the app from their phones.

Part 1 - Create the Firebase project

1. On your computer, open Firebase Console and sign in with Google.

2. Choose **Create a project**. Give it a simple name, for example **Tyep Delivery**, and follow the screens. Google Analytics is optional for this app; you can turn it off.

3. When the project is ready, open the gear icon next to Project Overview, then **Project settings**. Find and write down the **Project ID**. This is not the display name.

You will need the Project ID when publishing the app. Keep it handy.

Part 2 - Register the web app and copy its settings

1. In **Project settings**, scroll to **Your apps** and click the web icon that looks like **</>**.

2. Name it **Tyep Delivery Web** and choose **Register app**. You do not need to set up Firebase Hosting on this screen if it asks.

3. Firebase will show a web configuration. Copy these four values somewhere private and easy to find: **apiKey**, **authDomain**, **projectId**, and **appId**.

Safe to know: These four web-app settings are designed to be included in a browser app. They are not passwords. Do not copy a service-account JSON file or private key into the POS or rider app.

Part 3 - Turn on sign-in

1. In the Firebase menu, open **Authentication**, then click **Get started** if you see that button.

2. Open the **Sign-in method** tab, choose **Email/Password**, turn on the Email/Password option, and save.

Each rider and the POS delivery manager will have a separate account. Do not share one rider login among several people.

Part 4 - Create the database

1. Open **Firestore Database** in the Firebase menu and choose **Create database**.
2. Select **Production mode**. Do not choose test mode; the app relies on access rules to protect order and rider data.
3. Choose a location near your shop. Firebase may not let you change this location later without creating a new database.
4. Finish creating the database. Leave the database open; you will add profiles to it in Part 6.

Part 5 - Make the manager and rider sign-in accounts

Create one account for the person who will open Delivery in the POS, and one account for every rider.

1. Go to **Authentication**, open the **Users** tab, and choose **Add user**.
2. Enter the person's email and a strong temporary password, then create the user. Repeat for the manager and each rider.
3. In the Users list, find each new user and copy their **UID** (a long ID). You need the UID for the next part. Keep a note matching each UID to the person; the UID is not their email.

Keep passwords private. Give each person their own login details. The manager account is for the POS Delivery page; rider accounts are for the phone app.

Part 6 - Add each profile to Firestore

1. In **Firestore Database**, open the **Data** tab. Choose **Start collection** and name the collection exactly **deliveryRiders**.
2. For each user, create a document. In the Document ID box, paste that person's exact UID from Authentication. The document ID must not be their email.
3. Add these fields. Choose the matching field type in the console (string, boolean, number, or null).

Field	Manager value	Rider value
role (string)	manager	rider
name (string)	POS Manager	Rider's name
email (string)	Manager email	Rider email
enabled (boolean)	true	true
phone (string)	optional	Rider phone
area (string)	optional	Preferred area
activeCount (number)	not needed	0
lastLocation (null)	not needed	null

Exact spelling matters: use role values manager and rider, all lowercase. Each profile document ID must match that user's UID exactly.

Part 7 - Add the Firebase settings to the POS and rider app

The same four Firebase values go in two separate files. The root POS and the DAPP folder each read their own settings.

POS file: In VS Code, open the main project folder. Open the existing **.env** file in the top-level folder. If it does not exist, create a file named exactly **.env**. Add these lines, replacing the example text with your real values:

```
VITE_FIREBASE_API_KEY=your-api-key
VITE_FIREBASE_AUTH_DOMAIN=your-project.firebaseapp.com
VITE_FIREBASE_PROJECT_ID=your-project-id
VITE_FIREBASE_APP_ID=your-app-id
```

Rider app file: In the **DAPP** folder, copy **.env.example** to a new file named **.env**, then put the same four settings into it.

Do not delete other settings from an existing POS .env file. Do not add quote marks around values. Do not send either .env file to riders or post it online.

Part 8 - Publish the rules and rider app

This step needs the Mac Terminal. In VS Code you can open it from **Terminal > New Terminal**. The commands below assume this project is still in its current folder. If you moved it, use the new folder location instead.

1. Go to the DAPP folder:

```
cd "/Users/d87/Downloads/Projects/POS(mern)/WindowsPOSV2/DAPP"
```

2. Install the rider app packages if this is the first time on this computer:

```
npm install
```

3. Build the rider app:

```
npm run build
```

4. Sign in to Firebase:

```
npx firebase-tools login
```

A browser window should open. Sign in with the Google account that owns the Firebase project. If asked to install firebase-tools, allow it.

5. Publish the rider app and security rules: replace **your-project-id** with the Project ID from Part 1:

```
npx firebase-tools deploy --only hosting,firestore:rules --project your-project-id
```

Wait for a success message. Firebase will show a website address such as **https://your-project-id.web.app**. Copy that address; it is what riders will open on their phones.

If Firebase asks you questions you do not understand, stop and write down the exact question or error. Do not choose an option that says it will overwrite files.

Part 9 - Connect the POS and test with one rider

1. Fully close and reopen the POS so it reads the new settings. Open the POS **Delivery** page.

2. Sign in to the Delivery page using the Firebase **manager** account, not the normal cashier login.

3. Create a small test delivery order in the POS and confirm it appears in the Delivery page.

4. On one rider's phone, open the Firebase website address from Part 8. Sign in using that rider's account. Confirm the test order appears.

5. Test claiming the order, changing it to On the way, and marking it Delivered. Check that the POS shows the status. Once testing is complete, use normal rider accounts for real orders.

For day-to-day use, the POS computer and phones need internet. Riders can use their mobile data; they do not need the shop Wi-Fi password.

Optional - Put the rider app icon on a phone

Android: Open the website in Chrome, tap the browser menu, then choose **Install app** or **Add to Home screen**.

iPhone: Open the website in Safari, tap the Share button, then choose **Add to Home Screen**.

This creates an app-like shortcut for the web app. It is not an App Store or Play Store download.

If you get stuck

The app says Setup needed: Check that DAPP/.env exists and has all four real values; rebuild and redeploy after changing it.

The POS cannot connect: Check the top-level .env, then fully close and restart the POS.

Rider signs in but sees no orders: Check that the rider profile document ID is their exact Authentication UID, role is rider, and enabled is true.

Permission denied: Make sure you deployed Firestore rules to the same Project ID as the app settings.

Rider cannot open the app: They need the https://...web.app address and an internet connection. A localhost preview address only works on your computer.

Firebase asks about billing: Pause before agreeing. Check the current Firebase plan, pricing, and quotas first; offerings can change over time.

Tomorrow checklist

[ ] Create Firebase project and save its Project ID.

[ ] Register the web app and copy its four settings.

[ ] Enable Email/Password and create manager plus rider accounts.

[ ] Create deliveryRiders profiles using the exact user UIDs.

[ ] Add settings to both .env files.

[ ] Build, sign in, deploy Hosting and Firestore rules.

[ ] Test one order from the POS to a rider phone.

Project setup notes are also in DAPP/README.md. Take your time: the app should not be used for real deliveries until the database rules have been deployed and a test order has completed successfully.